



Your Private Backpack Coach™

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Your first backpack, finished in 7 days.

The Finish-It Plan: one small task a day, 45 to 90 minutes each, from choosing the pattern to taking the photo of your finished bag.

- ✓ A task, a time and a checklist for every day
- ✓ Checkpoints so mistakes never get past the next round
- ✓ A tracker to print and stick on the fridge

Why 7 days works

Most backpacks don't die from lack of skill. They die in the closet, half-finished, because nobody knew what to do next. This plan tells you what to do next, every day.

RULE 1 · SAME TIME, EVERY DAY

After dinner, before bed, during nap time — pick one slot and protect it. 45–90 minutes is enough.

RULE 2 · DONE BEATS PERFECT

Your first bag doesn't have to be flawless. It has to be finished. Bag #2 is where you get picky.

RULE 3 · CHECK AT EVERY CHECKPOINT

Each day ends with a "done when". If it's not true, fix it before tomorrow — that's what stops small mistakes from becoming a lost evening.

RULE 4 · STUCK FOR 5 MINUTES? ASK.

Don't put it down "for tomorrow". Open Your Private Backpack Coach™, say which pattern and which round, and keep going tonight.

Your 7-day tracker

DAY	TASK	TIME	STARTED	DONE
Day 1	Pick your bag & get everything ready	45 min	☐	☐
Day 2	The base	60 min	☐	☐
Day 3	Body, first half	60–75 min	☐	☐
Day 4	Body, second half & top band	60–75 min	☐	☐
Day 5	The flap	45–60 min	☐	☐
Day 6	Straps & hardware	60 min	☐	☐
Day 7	Assembly, finishing & photo	60–90 min	☐	☐

Missed a day? Don't restart — just do that day's task tomorrow. The plan moves with you.

Day 1

🕒 45 min

Pick your bag & get everything ready

- ☐ Choose a pattern marked **Beginner** on its spec sheet (page 1) — smaller is faster. Good first picks: Pattern 13 Little Bunny, 15 Happy Frog or 29 Little Penguin (kids, 6–8 h), or Pattern 18 Mini Festival or 44 Rainbow Mini (adult, 4–6 h).
- ☐ Read the pattern's 3 pages once, start to finish, without crocheting. Circle the stitches you don't know and look them up in your Illustrated Stitch Dictionary bonus.
- ☐ Gather everything on the materials list: yarn (all of it, same dye lot), hook, 4 stitch markers, tapestry needle, scissors, tape measure, hardware.
- ☐ Make the gauge swatch (Resize & Yarn-Swap Guide, page 2) and adjust the hook until it matches.

✓ **Done tonight when** Swatch done and matching the pattern's gauge.

If something goes wrong: The Fix-It Library, Fixes 35–36 — or ask your coach.

Day 2

🕒 60 min

The base

- ☐ Put a marker in the first stitch of round 1 and move it up every round.
- ☐ Count the stitches at the end of every single round, out loud if needed.
- ☐ Every 3 rounds, lay the base flat on the table — it must be flat, not a bowl, not a chip.
- ☐ Finish the last base round and the BLO turn-up round if your pattern has one.

✓ **Done tonight when** The base lies completely flat and the stitch count matches the pattern.

If something goes wrong: The Fix-It Library, Fixes 1–8 — or ask your coach.

Day 3

⌚ 60-75 min

Body, first half

- ☐ Work the wall rounds with the same count as the base — no increases.
- ☐ Decide where the seam line goes (center back or a side) and keep it there.
- ☐ At round 5 and round 10, measure the width. It must match the base width.
- ☐ Stop in the middle of a round if you have to, with a marker in the live loop so it doesn't unravel.

✓ **Done tonight when** Half the body height done, walls straight up, width unchanged.

If something goes wrong: The Fix-It Library, Fixes 9-15 — or ask your coach.

Day 4

⌚ 60–75 min

Body, second half & top band

- ☐ Finish the body rounds up to the height on the pattern (count rounds, see the Resize Guide if your height differs).
- ☐ Work the eyelet / drawstring round and test the cord through the first 5 holes before finishing the round.
- ☐ Work the top band rounds and fasten off. Weave in the ends now, both directions.
- ☐ Measure the bag width at the top: this is the number you'll need tomorrow for the flap.

✓ **Done tonight when** Body complete, ends woven, top width written down.

If something goes wrong: The Fix-It Library, Fixes 11–12, 32 — or ask your coach.

Day 5

⌚ 45–60 min

The flap

- ☐ Check your flap starting count against tonight's top width (width minus 1 cm / 0.4 in).
- ☐ Count every row — a flap that grows one stitch per row bows out.
- ☐ Work the edging round with 3 sc in each corner.
- ☐ Lay it flat. If it curls, spray, pin and let it dry overnight.

✓ **Done tonight when** The flap lies flat by itself and is 1 cm narrower than the bag.

If something goes wrong: The Fix-It Library, Fixes 16–21 — or ask your coach.

Day 6

🕒 60 min

Straps & hardware

- ☐ Make both straps in one sitting and with the same row count.
- ☐ Lay them flat, check they aren't twisted, and block them if they curl.
- ☐ Cut felt backings for the clasp and for the 4 strap attachment points.
- ☐ Attach the clasp to the flap through the felt patch.

✓ **Done tonight when** Two equal straps, clasp mounted on the flap with a backing.

If something goes wrong: The Fix-It Library, Fixes 22–27 — or ask your coach.

Day 7

🕒 60–90 min

Assembly, finishing & photo

- ☐ Pin the flap to the center back (centers first, then ends) and sew it with mattress stitch.
- ☐ Pin and sew the straps across at least 3 rounds of the body, with a box stitch over felt.
- ☐ Thread the drawstring, add the lining if your pattern has one, weave in every last end.
- ☐ Block the whole bag: spray, stuff with a towel, let it dry. Then take its photo in daylight — you finished it.

✓ **Done tonight when** A finished backpack. Photo taken.

If something goes wrong: The Fix-It Library, Fixes 28–34, 39–40 — or ask your coach.

PHOTO CHECKLIST (FOR YOU — OR FOR YOUR FIRST SALE)

- ☐ Daylight by a window, no flash.
- ☐ Plain background: a white sheet, a wooden floor or a wall.
- ☐ Bag stuffed with paper so it keeps its shape.
- ☐ One photo front, one side, one detail of the stitches, one worn on the shoulder.

Day 8: pick bag #2.

The second backpack takes half the time. You already know how the base behaves, where the seam goes and how to make the flap sit flat. 49 patterns are waiting.